



Kale

The crunchy leaf stalks can be eaten raw or stir-fried.

The bitter leaves become sweeter after a frost.



Bok choy

Red cabbage



The leaves of the red cabbage are sweeter and tougher than those of the white cabbage.

Tightly packed ball of leaves



Spinach



These delicate leaves lose water and shrivel up when cooked.

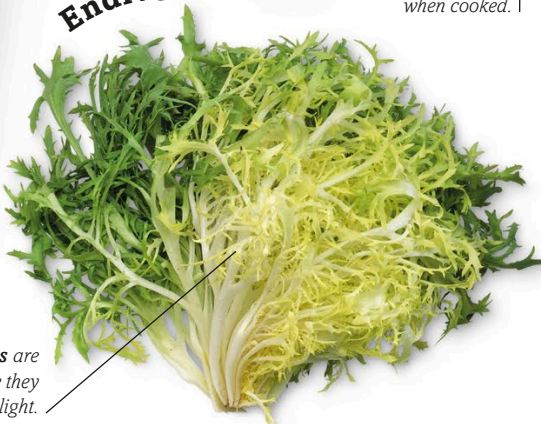


Watercress

These peppery leaves grow both on land and in streams.



Endive



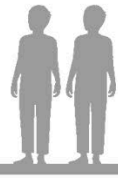
Inner leaves are pale because they receive less sunlight.



GIANT CABBAGE



Heaviest cabbage
(138 1/3 lb / 62.7 kg)



Children
(Weight of two children)

The heaviest cabbage ever grown was a whopping 138 1/3 lb (62.7 kg), the average weight of two young children. It was grown in Alaska in 2012.

For thousands of years, people have cultivated leafy vegetables to produce new varieties that give better harvests and more interesting flavors. The results of these gradual changes can be clearly seen in the differences between vegetables like **Brussels sprouts**, **savoy cabbage**, **kale**, **red cabbage**, and broccoli, all of which are the same species of plant.

Each was bred by humans for bigger leaves, more leaf buds, thicker leaf stalks, or different colors. The vibrant **rainbow chard** and **radicchio** plants seen today are also a result of careful selection by breeders over time. The crisp **lettuce**, too, was once a weed with prickly leaves and stems and was grown by the ancient Egyptians for its oily seeds.